Lesson 34

LAST DAYS SERIES - The Second Coming of Christ

Aim: To study the scriptural meaning and basis of The Second coming of Jesus Christ.

Introduction:

“Are you ready for the rapture of the church? Are you ready for Heaven? Our Lord Jesus Christ now wants all Christians to get into a sense of urgency in our preparation for His second coming.”— Doris Ijeoma Basil, A Sense of Urgency

“The second coming of Christ will be so revolutionary that it will change every aspect of life on this planet. Christ will reign in righteousness. Disease will be arrested. Death will be modified. War will be abolished. Nature will be changed. Man will live as it was originally intended he should live.”— Billy Graham, Billy Graham in Quotes

There are three Greek words used to reveal this fact:

1. Parousia - personal presence.
2. Apukalupsis - revelation

3. Epiphaneia- appearing

These three words signify that there will come a time when Christ will return in a public, personal revelation of Himself to the world. Some teach that the second coming is when at death "Jesus comes to receive the soul," but that would not be a public revelation visible to the world.

Acts 1:10,11- *10They were looking intently up into the sky as he was going, when suddenly two men dressed in white stood beside them. 11“Men of Galilee,” they said, “why do you stand here looking into the sky? This same Jesus, who has been taken from you into heaven, will come back in the same way you have seen him go into heaven.”*

Describes as being

1. Personal
2. Bodily
3. Visible and
4. With power

The Savior's first coming was in humiliation but the second coming will be glorious.

There are three (3) major view points respecting His second coming.

1. Post millennial view- it teaches that the second coming will follow rather that precede the millennial age.

2. The A-millennial view- supporters do not believe in a literal period of a thousand years but believe that when Christ

3. The revelation which is public (Revelation 1:7), when the Lord comes with His saints to set up the millennium

Revelation 1:7-7 *“Look, he is coming with the clouds and “every eye will see him, even those who pierced him”; and all peoples on earth “will mourn because of him. So shall it be! Amen.*

1 Thessalonians 3:13- *13May he strengthen your hearts so that you will be blameless and holy in the presence of our God and Father when our Lord Jesus comes with all his holy ones.*

An unsolved problem of pre- millennialists is whether the church will go through the tribulation so there are the " Pre- tribulation and mid- tribulation" debates.

I. PROPHECIES OF CHRIST'S SECOND COMING

His first coming was prophesied and those prophecies came to pass literally. That gives us confidence that the

prophecies of the Second Advent will also be fulfilled literally and not in a figurative or spiritual sense.

1. It was foretold by the prophets

Daniel 7:13- *13“In my vision at night I looked, and there before me was one like a son of man, coming with the clouds of heaven. He approached the Ancient of Days and was led into his presence.*

2. It was foretold by Jesus Himself.

Matthew 25:31- *31“When the Son of Man comes in his glory, and all the angels with him, he will sit on his glorious throne.*

3. It was foretold by Paul.

1 Timothy 6:14- *14to keep this command without spot or blame until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ,*

4. It was foretold by angels.

Acts 1:10,11- *10They were looking intently up into the sky as he was going, when suddenly two men dressed in white stood beside them. 11“Men of Galilee,” they said, “why do you stand here looking into the sky? This same Jesus, who has been taken from you into heaven, will come back in the same way you have seen him go into heaven.”*

II. TIME OF CHRIST'S COMING

This is a secret that only the Lord knows.

Matthew 24:36- *36“But about that day or hour no one knows, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son,[a] but only the Father.*

Jesus Christ as a man did not know the date but Jesus Christ as God is Omniscient and certainly knows the exact moment when it will occur.

Alban Douglas comment, "I believe it is movable date 2 Peter 3:12 that can be advanced or retarded depending on the speed or slowness of taking the Gospel to every tribe, Matthew 24:14.

2 Peter 3:12- *12as you look forward to the day of God and speed its coming. That day will bring about the destruction of the heavens by fire, and the elements will melt in the heat.*

Matthew 24:14- *14And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in the whole world as a testimony to all nations, and then the end will come.*

III. PURPOSE OF CHRIST'S COMING.

1. To complete the salvation of saints. He has delivered us from the power and penalty of sin.

Hebrews 9:28- *28so Christ was sacrificed once to take away the sins of many; and he will appear a second time, not to bear sin, but to bring salvation to those who are waiting for him.*

2. To be glorified in His saints.

2 Thess. 1:10- *10on the day he comes to be glorified in his holy people and to be marveled at among all those who have believed. This includes you, because you believed our testimony to you.*

3. To bring to light the hidden things of darkness.

1 Cor. 4:5- *5Therefore judge nothing before the appointed time; wait until the Lord comes. He will bring to light what is hidden in darkness and will expose the motives of the heart. At that time each will receive their praise from God.*

4. To Judge.

2 Tim. 4:1 - *In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead, and in view of his appearing and his kingdom, I give you this charge:*

5. To Reign.

Revelation 11:15- *15The seventh angel sounded his trumpet, and there were loud voices in heaven, which said: "The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom*

of our Lord and of his Messiah, and he will reign for ever and ever."

6. To receive us to be with Himself.

John 14:3- *3And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and take you to be with me that you also may be where I am.*

7. To destroy death.

1 Cor. 15: 25,26 - *25For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. 26The last enemy to be destroyed is death.*

IV. HOW IS CHRIST'S COMING.

A. Secretly at the Rapture.

1 Thess. 5:2 - *2for you know very well that the day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night.*

Matthew 24:44 - *44So you also must be ready, because the Son of Man will come at an hour when you do not expect him.*

Be prepared to meet Him today.

B. Publicly at the revelation.

Revelation 1:7 - *"Look, he is coming with the clouds," and "every eye will see him, even those who pierced him"; and all*

peoples on earth "will mourn because of him." So shall it be! Amen.

Matthew 24:30 - *30"Then will appear the sign of the Son of Man in heaven. And then all the peoples of the earth[a] will mourn when they see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven, with power and great glory.*

Titus 2:13 - *13while we wait for the blessed hope—the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ,*

V. WHERE IS CHRIST'S COMING TO?

A. At the Rapture we will meet Him in the Air.

1 Thess. 4:17 *17After that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will be with the Lord forever.*

B. At the Revelation we will descend with Him to the earth. Probably He will land on the Mount of Olives.

Zechariah 14:4 - *4On that day his feet will stand on the Mount of Olives, east of Jerusalem, and the Mount of Olives will be split in two from east to west, forming a great valley, with half of the mountain moving north and half moving south.*

VI. MANNER OF HIS COMING

1. In the clouds.

Matthew 24:30 - *30“Then will appear the sign of the Son of Man in heaven. And then all the peoples of the earth will mourn when they see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven, with power and great glory.*

2. In the glory of His Father.

Matthew 16:27 - *27For the Son of Man is going to come in his Father’s glory with his angels, and then he will reward each person according to what they have done.*

3. In His own glory.

Matthew 25:31 - *31“When the Son of Man comes in his glory, and all the angels with him, he will sit on his glorious throne.*

4. In flaming fire.

2 Thess. 1:8 - *8He will punish those who do not know God and do not obey the gospel of our Lord Jesus.*

5. With power and great glory.

Matthew 24:30 - *30“Then will appear the sign of the Son of Man in heaven. And then all the peoples of the earth will mourn when they see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven, with power and great glory.*

6. As He ascended, in bodily form

Acts 1: 9-11 - *9After he said this, he was taken up before their very eyes, and a cloud hid him from their sight. 10They were looking intently up into the sky as he was going, when suddenly two men dressed in white stood beside them. 11"Men of Galilee," they said, "why do you stand here looking into the sky? This same Jesus, who has been taken from you into heaven, will come back in the same way you have seen him go into heaven."*

7. With the shout and the voice of the archangel.

1 Thess. 4:16 - *16For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first.*

8. With His saints.

1 Thess. 3: 13 - *13May he strengthen your hearts so that you will be blameless and holy in the presence of our God and Father when our Lord Jesus comes with all his holy ones.*

9. Accompanied by Angels.

Matthew 16:27 - *27For the Son of Man is going to come in his Father's glory with his angels, and then he will reward each person according to what they have done.*

10. Suddenly.

Mark 13:36 - *36If he comes suddenly, do not let him find you sleeping.*

VII. SIGNS OF CHRIST'S COMING

2 Timothy 3:1-7 - *But mark this: There will be terrible times in the last days. 2People will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boastful, proud, abusive, disobedient to their parents, ungrateful, unholy, 3without love, unforgiving, slanderous, without self-control, brutal, not lovers of the good, 4treacherous, rash, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God— 5having a form of godliness but denying its power. Have nothing to do with such people.6They are the kind who worm their way into homes and gain control over gullible women, who are loaded down with sins and are swayed by all kinds of evil desires, 7always learning but never able to come to a knowledge of the truth.*

LISTS 23 SIGNS OFHIS COMING, MOST OF WHICH ARE EVIDENT TODAY

1. Perilous times
2. Men loving themselves
3. Covetousness
4. Boasting
5. Proud

6. Blasphemy

7. Disobedient to parents

8. Unthankful

9. Unholy

10. Without natural affection

11. Truce-breakers (unforgiving)

12. False accusers

13. Incontinent (without self-control)

14. Fierce (brutal)

15. Despising good

16. Traitors

17. Heady (rash)

18. High minded (conceited)

19. Lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God.

20. Having a form of godliness

21. Silly women laden with sins

22. Divers lusts (all kinds of evil desires.)

23. Ever learning and never able to come to the knowledge of truth.

Matthew 24:5-7,12-38 *5For many will come in my name, claiming, 'I am the Messiah,' and will deceive many. 6You*

will hear of wars and rumors of wars, but see to it that you are not alarmed. Such things must happen, but the end is still to come. 7Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. There will be famines and earthquakes in various places.

LISTS TEN SIGNS

1. False Christ's
2. Wars and rumors of wars.
3. Famines
4. Pestilences
5. Earthquakes
6. Iniquity to abound
7. Love of many waxes cold
8. Eating
9. Drinking
10. Marrying

OTHER SIGNS INCLUDE:

<u>1. The destruction of Jerusalem</u>

Luke 21:20,24 - *20“When you see Jerusalem being surrounded by armies, you will know that its desolation is near. 24They will fall by the sword and will be taken as*

prisoners to all the nations. Jerusalem will be trampled on by the Gentiles until the times of the Gentiles are fulfilled.

2. The completion of the church.

Romans 11:25 - *25I do not want you to be ignorant of this mystery, brothers and sisters, so that you may not be conceited: Israel has experienced a hardening in part until the full number of the Gentiles has come in.*

3. Gospel preached everywhere.

Matthew 24:14 - *14And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in the whole world as a testimony to all nations, and then the end will come.*

4. The coming of the anti-Christ.

2 Thess. 2:3-8 - *3Don't let anyone deceive you in any way, for that day will not come until the rebellion occurs and the man of lawlessness[a] is revealed, the man doomed to destruction. 4He will oppose and will exalt himself over everything that is called God or is worshiped, so that he sets himself up in God's temple, proclaiming himself to be God. 5Don't you remember that when I was with you I used to tell you these things? 6And now you know what is holding him back, so that he may be revealed at the proper time. 7For the secret power of lawlessness is already at work; but the one who now holds it back will continue to do so till he is taken out of the way. 8And*

then the lawless one will be revealed, whom the Lord Jesus will overthrow with the breath of his mouth and destroy by the splendor of his coming.

CONCLUSION

Be not a scoffer like those in 2 Peter 3:3 for His coming is sure and certain.

Is it right to sell everything and sit on a hilltop waiting for Him?

Definitely NOT!

We ought to plan and work as if He were not coming for another century but a holy life and pure life as if He were to return today.

1 Thess. 3:12,13

This doctrine must affect our lives. It ought to keep us busy and watching.

2 Peter 3:3- *3Above all, you must understand that in the last days scoffers will come, scoffing and following their own evil desires.*

1 Thess. 3:12,13 - *12May the Lord make your love increase and overflow for each other and for everyone else, just as ours does for you. 13May he strengthen your hearts so that you will*

be blameless and holy in the presence of our God and Father when our Lord Jesus comes with all his holy ones.